Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ K 10 7 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 3

♠ K Q J 10 9
♥ A
♦ 9 7 3
♣ Q J 5 2

♠ A 6 5 3
♥ J 6
♦ 10 6 2
♣ A 10 9 7

♠ 8
♥ Q 9 8 5 3
♦ K J 8 5
♣ 8 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦2

The bidding has been as shown.

When you have a weak, distributional hand with 5 of partner's suit an immediate jump to game is usually the best approach. If he has a good hand you will probably make the contract. If he is minimum then you might get a preemptive effect and stop your LHO from entering the bidding.

This is a good example. Partner may be lucky and make 4♥. But if they had had an opportunity to compete the opponents might well be able to make 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 10 6
♥ 10 9 2
♦ K 9 5
♣ A Q 9 4

♠ A K 9 7 2
♥ Q 5
♦ 7 4 2
♣ 10 6 5

♠ 3
♥ A K J 8 7 3
♦ A Q J 3
♣ 7 3

♠ Q 8 5 4
♥ 6 4
♦ 10 8 6
♣ K J 8 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
1♠	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♥4

The bidding has been as shown.

You can't support partner's ♥s with only 2 of them so you bid your nice ♠ suit. Partner then jumps to 3♥. Now

Here's where a lot of players go wrong. Since they only promised 4 ♠s with their first response they think they should now rebid them to show partner they had 5. And this **MIGHT** work if it turns out partner has 3 ♠s. Not only is this a risky bid, it is unnecessary. When partner jump rebid ♥s he showed 16-18 points and 6 ♥s. So you know of an 8-card fit and you know you should be in game. Bid 4♥.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ 8 5 ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ A K Q 5	
♠ 6 5 ♥ Q J 10 6 ♦ 9 6 ♣ J 9 8 6 3	N W E S	♠ 8 4 ♥ K 7 4 3 ♦ A 10 8 5 ♣ 10 7 2
	♠ A Q 10 9 3 ♥ A 9 2 ♦ K Q J 3 ♣ 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥Q

The bidding has been as shown.

As soon as partner opens 1♠ you know you will settle for nothing less than the ♠ game. The problem with bidding 4♠ right now is that partner will take you for the "weak-distributional-with-five-trumps" hand. So you temporize by first bidding 2♣. Partner rebids 2♦.

You now jump to 4♠, completing the picture of an opening hand with good ♠ support. Partner bids 4NT. What say you?

This is Blackwood so you answer 5♦ for one Ace. Partner says 6♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 4 3 2 ♥ Q ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ 9 6 5 4 2	
♠ 7 5 ♥ A K 10 7 6 4 ♦ K J ♣ Q J 10		♠ A K 10 8 ♥ 9 8 5 3 ♦ Q 10 9 6 ♣ 8
	♠ Q 9 6 ♥ J 2 ♦ A 8 5 3 ♣ A K 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♠3

The bidding has been as shown.

You could bid 1♠. Many would do so, thinking "I have to show partner my ♠ suit."

In fact, you don't have to show partner your ♠ suit. You already know of a partnership 9-card fit in ♥s, so there is no reason to search for a possible 8-card fit in ♠s.

With 11 points and 4 trumps you bid 3♥, a limit raise. Partner raises to game.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K Q 10 8 ♥ Q 6 ♦ Q J 9 6 ♣ A 9 6	
♠ 7 5 ♥ 10 9 3 2 ♦ 4 3 2 ♣ Q J 10 8		♠ J 4 3 ♥ 8 5 ♦ A K 8 7 ♣ K 5 4 2
	♠ A 9 6 2 ♥ A K J 7 4 ♦ 10 5 ♣ 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦K

The bidding has been as shown.

You **MIGHT** jump to 2NT to "show your points". However, a notrump bid now would deny a 4-card ♠ suit. Instead, your priority is to show that Major, so you respond 1♠. Partner bids 2♠. What do you say next?

Partner would not support a response which might be 4 cards unless he had 4 himself. Knowing that you have two opening hands facing each other, each containing 4 ♠s, you bid the ♠ game.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 4 ♥ A 9 5 4 2 ♦ A 9 8 2 ♣ 8 4 3	
♠ K Q 8 6 ♥ J 7 6 ♦ Q J 7 6 ♣ 9 6	N W E S	♠ A 10 9 7 5 ♥ K Q ♦ K 10 5 ♣ A J 7
	♠ J 3 2 ♥ 10 8 3 ♦ 4 3 ♣ K Q 10 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♣K

The bidding has been as shown.

With 4-card support you respond 2♠. Partner raises to 3♠. What do you say next?

Partner's bid is an invitation. You have told him you have 6-10 points and he probably has about 17-18. If you are at the high end of your 6-10 he wants you to bid game, at the low end he wants you to pass. You actually have 10, definitely high end, so you bid 4♠.